SUID-AFRIKAANSE POLISIEDIENS SOUTH AFRICAN POLICE SERVICE

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DIVISIONAL COMMISSIONER
VISIBLE POLICING AND OPERATIONS
HEAD OFFICE

All Provincial Commissioners

GUIDELINES FOR PROCESSING FIREARM LICENCE AND COMPETENCY CERTIFICATE APPLICATIONS WITHIN HUNDERD AND TWENTY (120) WORKING DAYS

1. This directive aims to provide internal guidance to Designated Firearm Officers (DFO's) at all levels in respect of acknowledgement, processing and time frames that needs to be followed to ensure the finalisation of firearm licences and competency certificates applications within a reasonable period, preferably within hundred and twenty (120) working days.

2. It is emphasised that the period of one hundred and twenty (120) working days is not prescribed in either the Firearms Control Act,2000(Act No. 60 of 2000) or the Firearms Control Regulations, 2004, promulgated in terms of that Act. Rather, this period has evolved through administrative practice over time as a reasonable timeframe within which applications for firearm licences and competency certificates are processed, in accordance with the principles of lawful, reasonable, and procedurally fair administrative action, and in the public interest.

3. **Definition of indicators as per the Technical Indicator Description (TID)**

3.1 The indicator, "Percentage of 90% of firearm application/competency certificate applications finalised within 120 working days".

3.1.1 The indicator relates to the percentage of new firearm licence and competency certificate applications that are finalised by the SAPS, within 120 working days.

3.1.2 All new firearm licence/competency certificate applications are regarded as finalised once they are approved, refused or cancelled on the EFRS system.

3.1.3 The counting rule for the 120 working days commences from the day that the application is registered on the system, to the day on which the application is finalised as approved, refused and or cancelled on the system.

3.1.4 Performance includes applications that are finalised and were carried over (received prior to 1 April of each reporting period).

GUIDELINES FOR PROCESSING FIREARM LICENCE AND COMPETENCY CERTIFICATE APPLICATIONS WITHIN HUNDERD AND TWENTY (120) WORKING DAYS

4. Business Process Flow

4.1 Station level

4.1.1 Responsibilities of the Station Designated Firearm Officer (DFO)

The Station DFO must:

- Hand over the application form to the applicant, give advice on the completion of the form and required supporting documents;
- Applications **must only be date stamped after they have been verified as completed** in all respects; the **receipt date stamp must correspond with the receipt date on the system** (EFRS);
- Receive application form from the applicant;
- Check for completeness and correctness of the application;
- Register the application form on the SAPS 86 Register (SAPS 86 number must be written on the application form);
- Check firearm status on EFRS function 10.5;
- Complete relevant information on the application form;
- Capture application on the system within 72 hours;
- Write application number on the application form at the provided space in red ink;
- Give application back to the applicant to make payment at the finance office at the station;
- On receipt of application back from finance office, **DFO must check receipt and confirm payment received on the EFRS**;
- Confirm on the checklist that the payment receipt is attached on the application form;
- Conduct safe inspection at the applicant's premises and interview with reference provided by applicant;
- Complete forwarding schedule with confirmation of number of pages on the application; and
- Forward all complete applications to the Provincial office within **40 working days** from the date of receipt; and
- In the event that any of the aforesaid steps could not be completed within the specified timeframe, the DFO **must** record the reasons therefore in writing, to accompany the application.

4.1.2 Responsibilities of the Station Finance Personnel

The station finance personnel must:

- Receive application form and payment (cash) from the applicant;
- Capture payment on the POLFIN with SAPS 86 number as reference;
- Stamp and sign the receipt;
- Attach the receipt on the relevant application form and;
- Hand back the application to the applicant; and
- In the event that any of the aforesaid steps could not be completed by the station finance personnel on any given day, the applicant must be informed there and then of the reason and the DFO **must** record the reason therefore in writing, to accompany the application.

GUIDELINES FOR PROCESSING FIREARM LICENCE AND COMPETENCY CERTIFICATE APPLICATIONS WITHIN HUNDERD AND TWENTY (120) WORKING DAYS

4.2 **Provincial level**

4.2.1 Responsibilities of the Provincial Designated Firearm Officer (DFO)

The Provincial DFO must:

- Receive applications from the station DFO;
- Reconcile the number of applications received with the EFRS;
- Conduct quality check for the completeness and correctness of information on each application;
- Update status of applications on the EFRS;
- Send incomplete applications back to the station including applications without proof of payment and mark them on the forwarding schedule;
- Acknowledged receipt of complete applications on the forwarding schedule and hand back signed forwarding schedule together with incomplete applications to the station DFO;
- Compile new forwarding schedule for applications to be forwarded to CFR under the signature of a commissioned officer; and
- Forward applications to CFR within **20 working days** from date of receipt from the station DFO; and
- In the event that any of the aforesaid steps could not be completed within the specified timeframe, the Provincial DFO **must** record the reasons therefore in writing and inform CFR thereof upon forwarding the applications.

4.3 **National Office Level**

4.3.1 Responsibilities of Central Firearm Register (CFR)

Central Firearm Register must:

- Receive application from Provincial DFO;
- Reconcile the number of applications receive with the EFRS;
- Conduct quality check for the completeness and correctness of each application;
- Update status of applications on the EFRS;
- Send incomplete applications back to Provincial DFO including applications without proof of payment and mark them on the forwarding schedule;
- Acknowledged receipt of applications on the forwarding schedule and hand back signed forwarding schedule together with incomplete applications to the Provincial DFO;
- Forward applications to the relevant section within **10 working days** from date of receipt from the Provincial DFO; and
- The sections within CFR must process and finalise application within **50 working days** from date of receipt from AVS.

5. **Reporting Requirements**

5.1 Station Level

- The Station must verify the information captured on the EFRS with the information on the SAPS 86 register to ensure that the information is the same and that the

number of firearms/competency applications correspond with the physical applications submitted.

5.2 Provincial level

- The provinces must verify the above information with what is captured on the SharePoint report on a monthly basis. An analysis must be conducted to identify the long-outstanding applications that are still at the stations.

5.3 National Level

- CFR must verify the above information with what is captured on the SharePoint report on a monthly basis. An analysis must be conducted on quarterly basis to identify the long-outstanding applications with more than sixty (60) working days that are still at the provinces and stations.

6. Internal Controls

- The Firearm Control Act, 2000 (Act No. 60 of 2000);
- Firearm Control Regulation of 2004; and
- Technical Indicator Description 2026/2027

7. Method of Calculation

7.1. The indicator is measured by the number of firearm license/competency certificate applications received within a certain period of time and finalised within 120 working days. The counting rule for the 120 working days commences from the day that the application is captured on the system, to the day on which the application is finalised as approved, refused and or cancelled.

7.2 The method of calculation for this indicator is non-cumulative. The number of new firearm licence /competency certificates applications that are finalised within 120 working days, divided by the number of firearm applications finalised within a specified reporting period, multiplied by 100, therefore, expressed as a percentage.

$$= \left(\frac{\textit{Total number of Firearm applications finalised within 120 working days}}{\textit{Total Finalised within the quarter}} \boldsymbol{x100} \right)$$

8. Source Document Requirement

The source document required in this indicator is the Enhanced Firearm Registrations System (EFRS) and SharePoint Reports from station to national level.

9. Consequence Management

9.1 The following measures shall apply in instances of non-compliance by any Designated Firearms Officer (DFO), at any level, with the prescribed guidelines and processes relating to the handling of firearm licence applications and competency certificates.

9.2 Consequence management must apply whether first or continuous non-compliance occur (Immediate commander to take steps against the responsible person).

GUIDELINES FOR PROCESSING FIREARM LICENCE AND COMPETENCY CERTIFICATE APPLICATIONS WITHIN HUNDERD AND TWENTY (120) WORKING DAYS

10. The contents of this guidelines must be brought to the attention of all DFO's for compliance.

11. Certificate confirming receipt of this directive, signed by the Provincial Heads: Firearm Liquor and Second-Hands Goods Services must be forwarded to: SikhakhaneP@saps.gov.za within fourteen (14) days of receipt of this document.

12. The previous internal directive on the subject matter with reference No. **27/5/2/1,** dated **2012-05-24** is forthwith rescinded.

LIEUTENANT GENERAL
DIVISIONAL COMMISSIONER: VISIBLE POLICING AND OPERATIONS
MJ MAMOTHETI

Date: 2026 -06- 01